Building Agents with Copilot Studio

Day 8 - GPO Microsoft 365 Copilot Learning Series | GCC Tenant

Today's Arc

1	**Module 1** Agents, Copilot Studio, and the GCC Landscape **(25 min)**
2	**Module 2** Build a Knowledge-Grounded Agent **(45 min)**
3	**Module 3** From Answers to Action - Topics, Tools, and Agent Flows **(45 min)**
4	**Module 4** Publish, Secure, Govern, and Measure **(35 min)**
5	**Module 5** Multi-Agent Patterns and the Road Ahead **(30 min)**
6	**Module 6** Capstone Design Sprint, Q&A, and Close **(25 min)**

Our GCC Stance

Verified Content

Everything demonstrated today is documented for Copilot Studio US Government

Clearly Labeled

Commercial-only capabilities are labeled on slides - not demoed in a commercial tenant

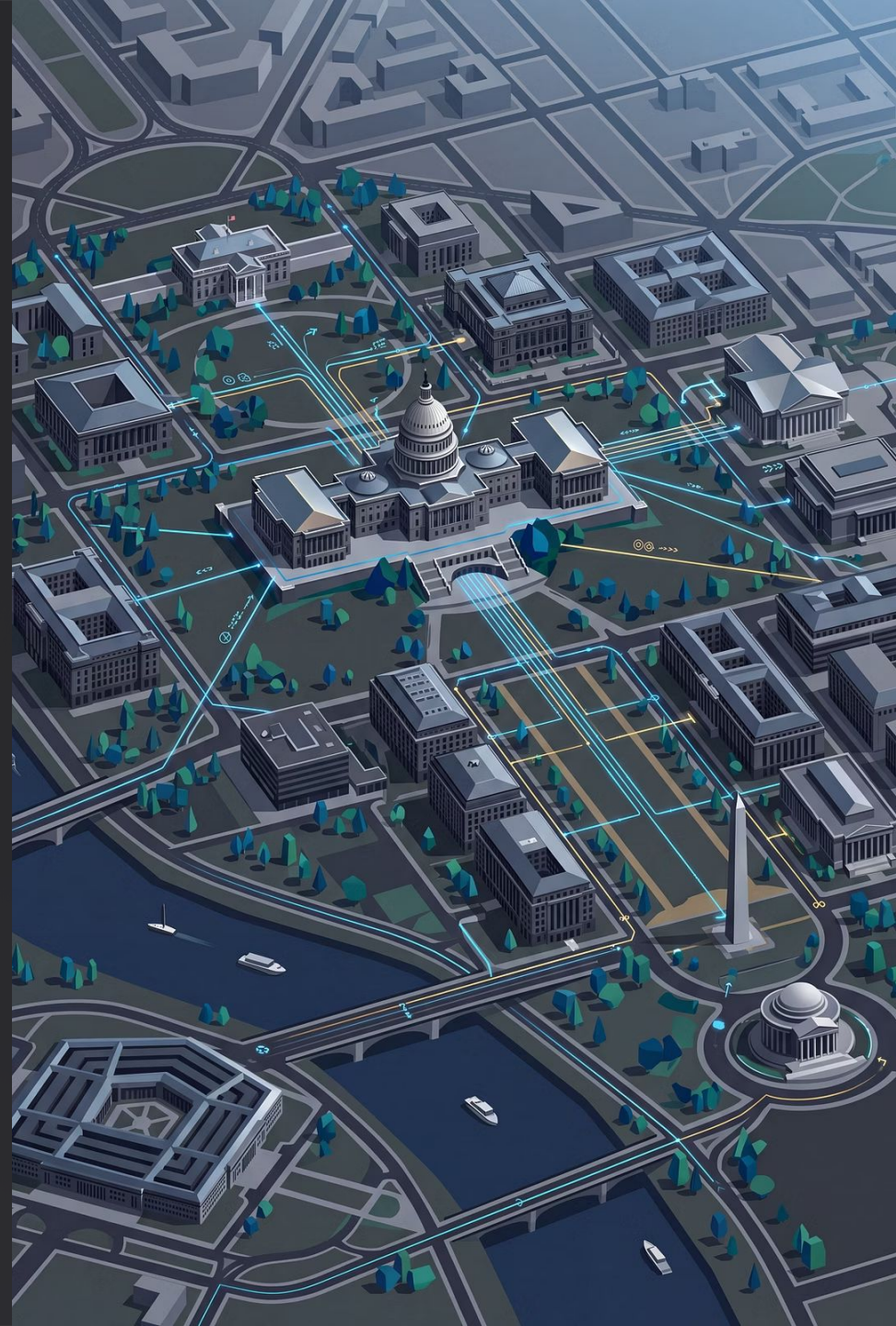
Monday-Ready

You leave with an accurate picture of what you can build on Monday morning

MODULE 1

Agents, Copilot Studio, and the GCC Landscape

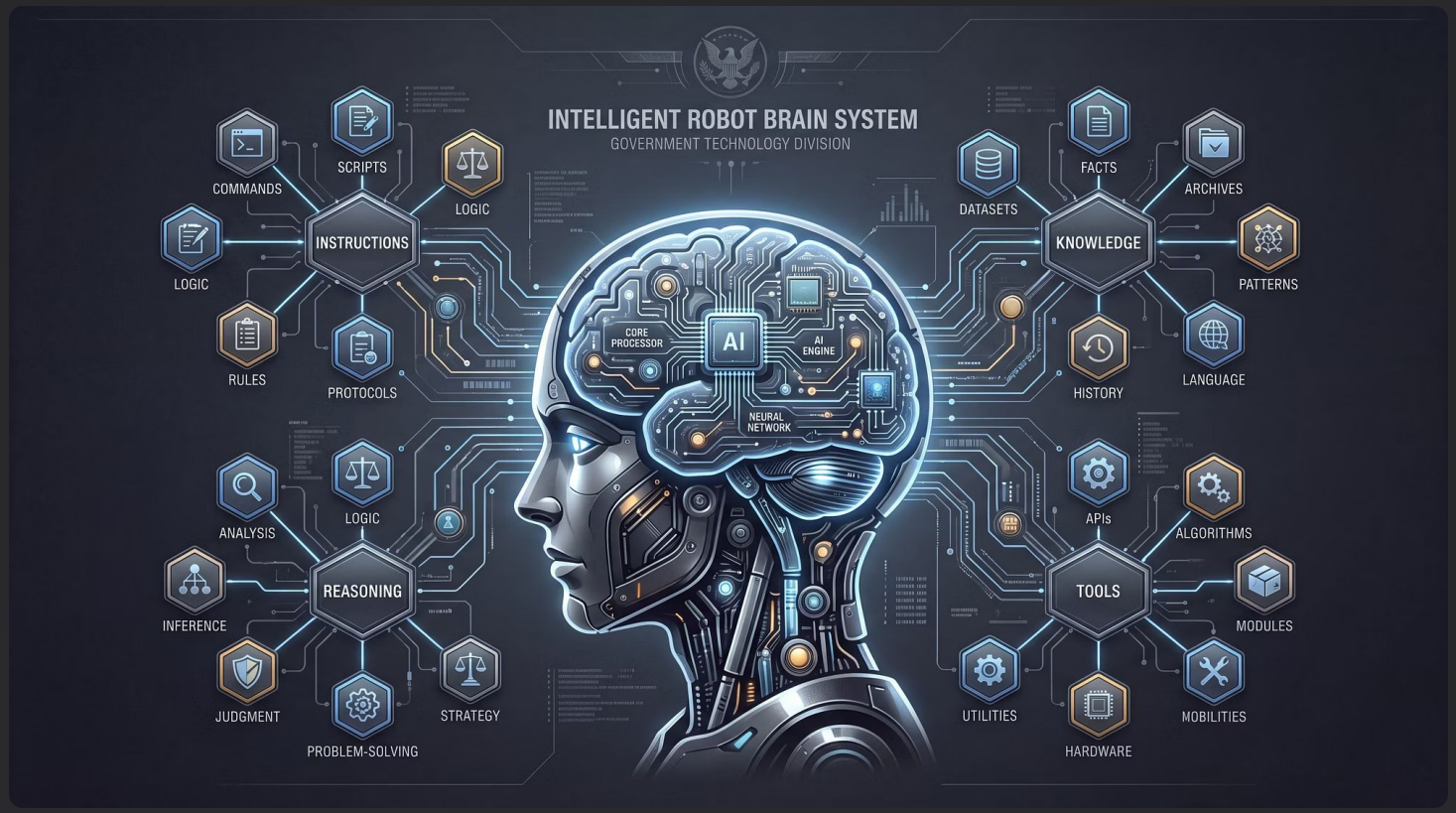
Understanding the platform, the compliance boundary, and where you stand as a GCC tenant.



What Is an Agent?

- **Instructions** - define its role, scope, and boundaries
- **Knowledge** - grounds its answers in your content
- **Tools** - let it take action beyond answering
- **Orchestrator** - decides which to use on each turn

> A chatbot follows a script. An agent reasons over a goal.



The Agent Spectrum in GCC

1

Built-in Agents

Researcher and Analyst in Copilot Chat

2

Agent Builder

Quick declarative agents in Copilot Chat

3

SharePoint Agents

Scoped to a site

4

Copilot Studio

Full-featured: knowledge, tools, topics, channels, governance

5

Pro-Code

Microsoft 365 Agents SDK, Microsoft Foundry, Microsoft Agent Framework

Tiers 1 through 4 are documented for GCC today. Tier 5 is partial: Agents Toolkit publishing is not supported in Government tenants. Verify pro-code paths in your tenant before committing.

Anatomy of a Copilot Studio Agent

Overview

Description, instructions, model

Knowledge

SharePoint, files, Dataverse, connectors

Tools

Connectors, prompt tools, agent flows, REST APIs

Topics

Authored conversation paths

Channels

Teams, M365 Copilot, web, and more

Analytics

Measure quality and usage

Harnesses Explained

Standard Harness

Rule-based agents, topics, agent flows - the harness documented for GCC. **Use this today.**

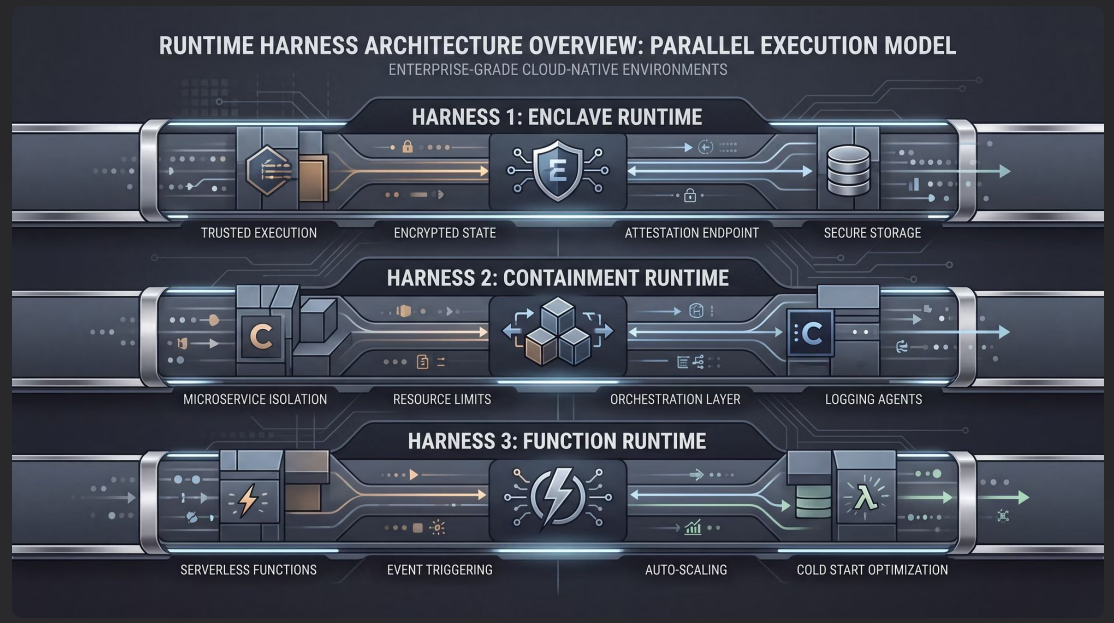
Copilot Chat Harness

Extends Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat with your knowledge. Available in GCC.

GitHub Copilot Harness

Reasoning-heavy, multistep work. GA in commercial (August 2026). **Not listed for GCC.**

> Note: The GitHub Copilot harness is a Copilot Studio framework - not the GitHub Copilot service.



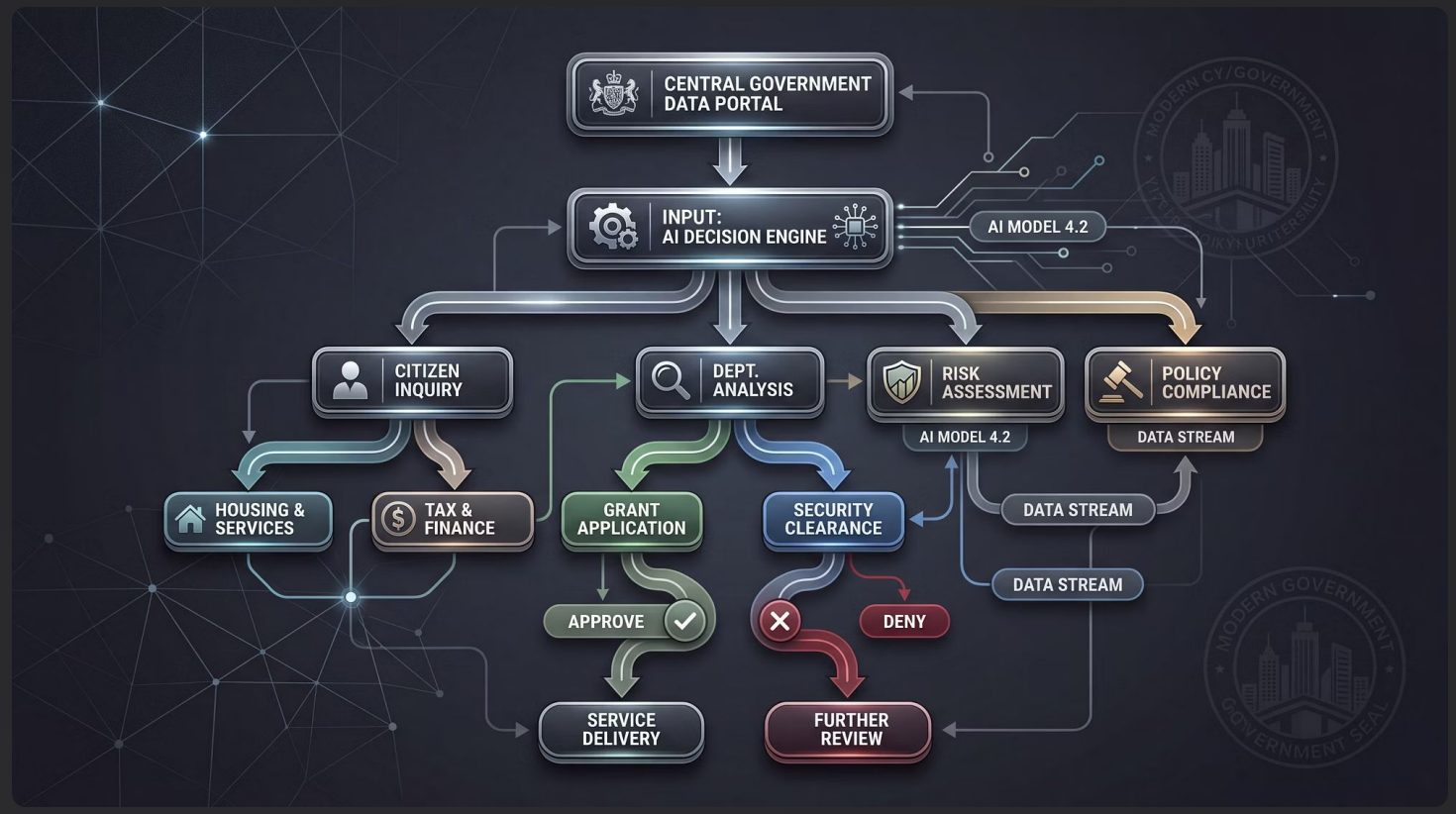
Orchestration Modes

Generative Orchestration

The model selects among knowledge, tools, and topics based on their descriptions. **Available in GCC - default for this course.**

Classic Orchestration

Relies on trigger phrases to route conversations. More deterministic, less flexible.



GCC Essentials

URL

gcc.powerva.microsoft.us

Data Residency

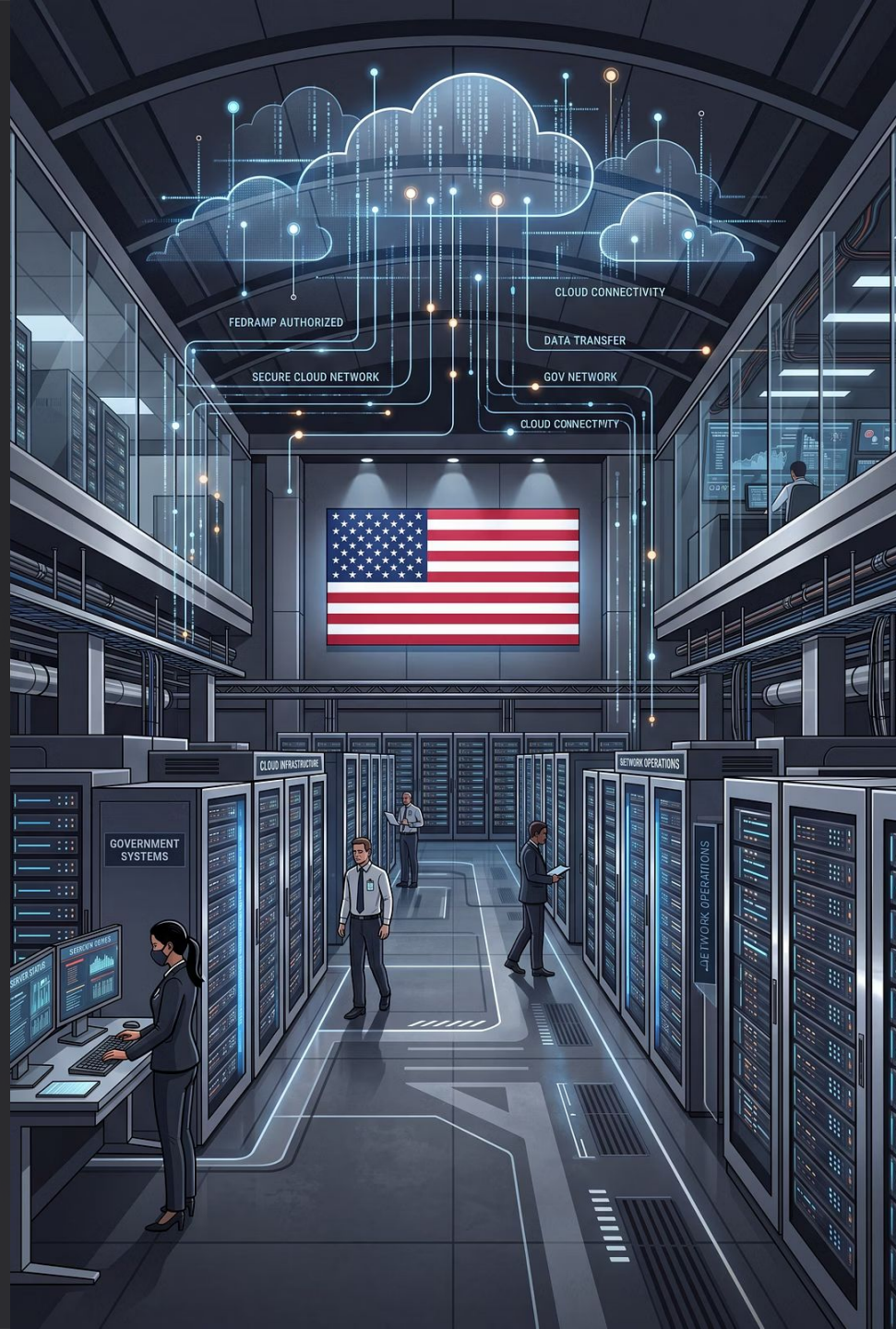
US datacenters on Azure Government; customer content stored in the United States

Access

Restricted to screened US personnel; designed to support FedRAMP High

AI Model

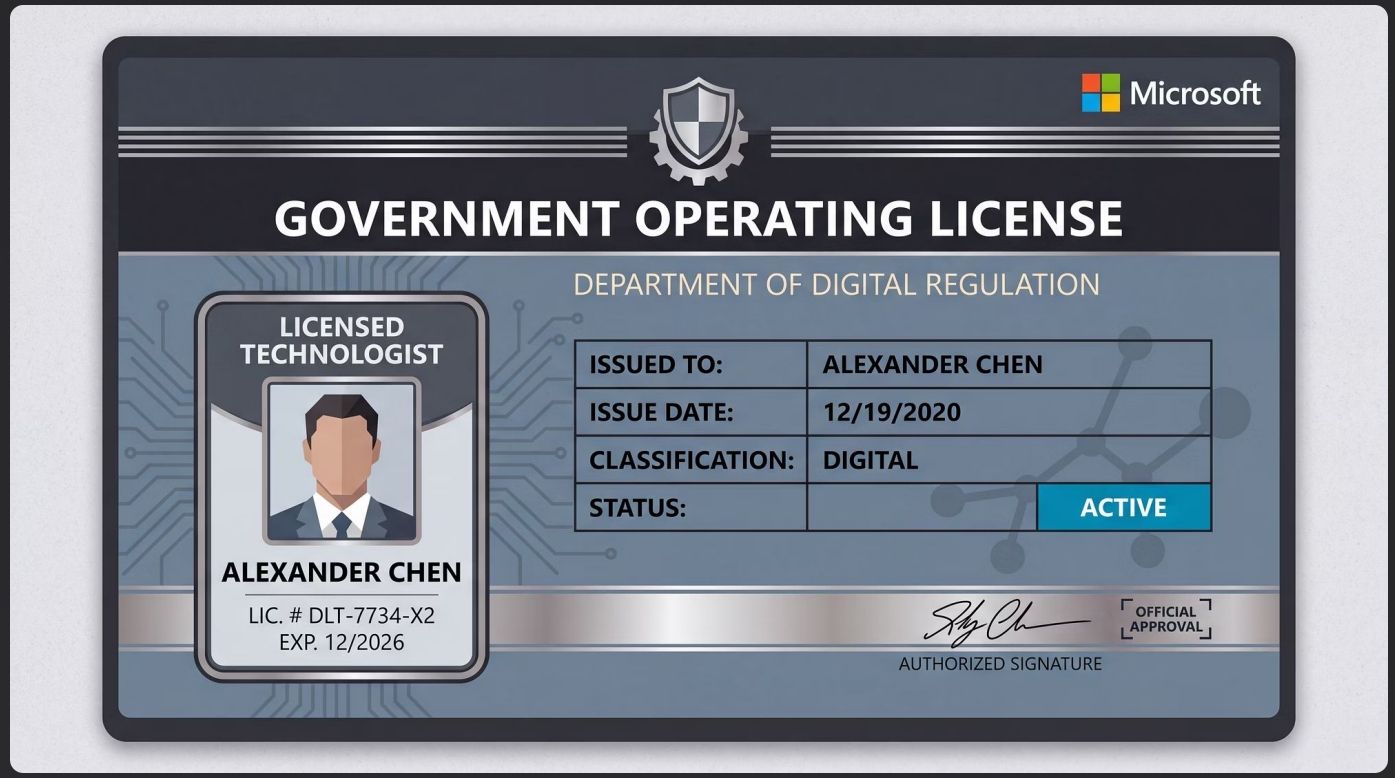
GPT-4o is the default - model picker may allow selection of alternatives



Licensing in One Slide

- Copilot Studio US Government licensing matches public cloud structure
- **Copilot Credits** - the common currency for Copilot Studio usage
- A Microsoft 365 Copilot license lets users work with agents that extend Microsoft 365 Copilot

⚠ The Copilot Studio for Microsoft Teams plan bundled with some M365 plans is **not available** for government plans.



Which Tool Would You Use?

"I want Copilot Chat to answer from my team's SharePoint handbook"

Use **Agent Builder** or a **SharePoint agent** - quick declarative setup, available in GCC

"I want an agent that creates a support request and emails the requester"

Use **Copilot Studio** - full tool support with agent flows and connectors

"I want an agent that watches a mailbox and acts on its own every hour"

Not available in GCC today via autonomous triggers - see interim patterns in Module 5

MODULE 2

Build a Knowledge-Grounded Agent

From blank screen to a working Publications Help Desk agent - grounded, governed, and citation-ready.

Two Ways to Start an Agent

Describe in Natural Language

Copilot Studio generates a name, description, and starter instructions automatically - fast start for most use cases

Start Blank

Full control from the first field - choose this when you have precise requirements ready

Instructions That Work

Five Elements Every Instruction Should Cover

1 Role

What the agent is and who it serves

2 Audience

Who will be asking questions

3 Scope and Tone

What is in bounds and how to communicate

4 Unknowns

How to handle questions outside scope

5 Citation Instruction

"Always include an in-text citation to the source document for every statement"

Well-written instructions are the most teachable artifact in the agent - read them aloud to check for clarity.

Knowledge Sources in GCC

SharePoint

Graph search, honors asking user's permissions, up to 25 URLs in generative mode

Uploaded Documents

Stored in Dataverse; not counted against the 25-source limit

Dataverse and Connectors

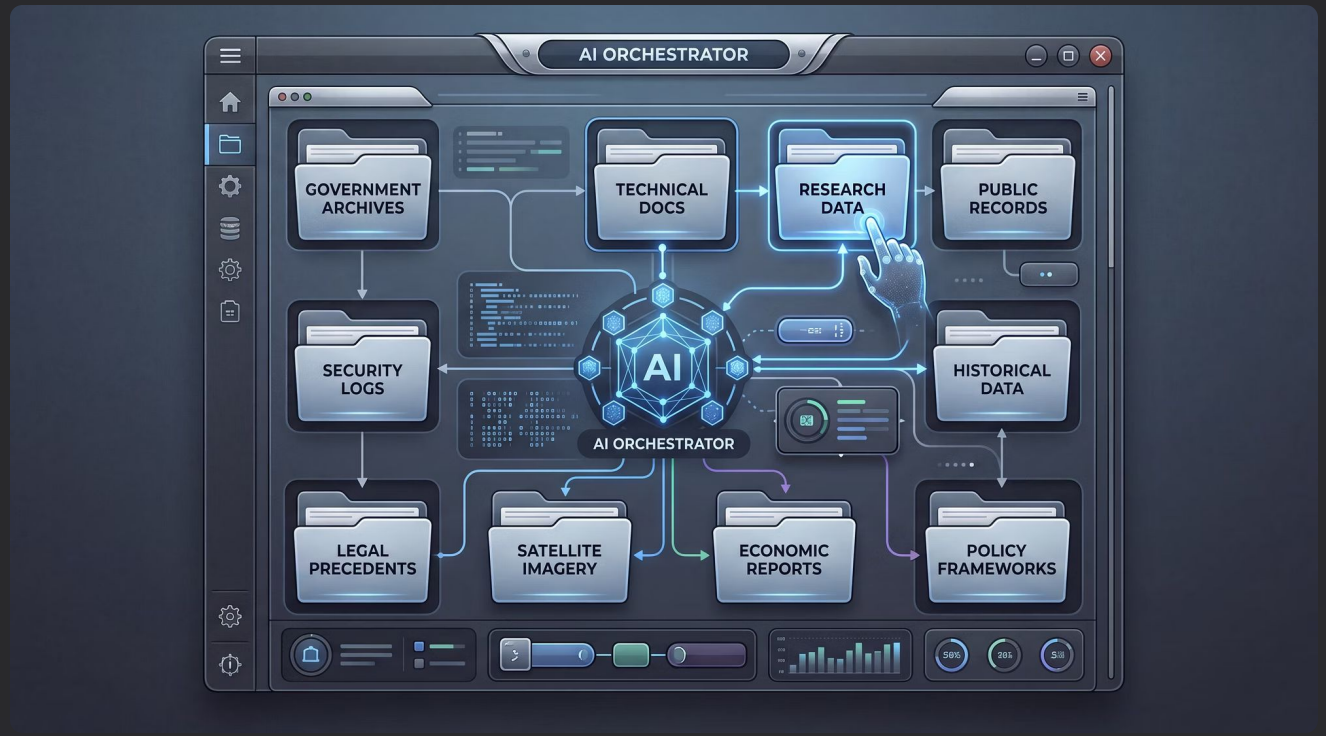
Dataverse tables and enterprise data through Copilot connectors

Web Search

Requires Bing consent; **off by default in government clouds**

Azure AI Search / Enhanced Search

Not available in GCC



How the Orchestrator Chooses

- With generative orchestration, **knowledge source descriptions matter**
- When there are more than 25 sources, the agent filters by description using an internal model
- Write descriptions the way you would explain a folder to a new colleague

Think of each knowledge source description as a label on a filing cabinet - the more precise, the better the agent routes.

Minutes to a Grounded Agent

- Create **"Publications Help Desk (Live Build)"** - paste instructions, confirm generative orchestration is on
- Add **SharePoint library URL** and upload the Style Quick Reference PDF
- Test with three questions - show **citations, activity view,** and a room-supplied question

Allow Ungrounded Responses

On (Default)

Agent can answer from model knowledge when no knowledge source or tool was used - broader but less controlled

Off

Any turn with no grounded source routes to the fallback topic - safer scope, but follow-up questions from conversation history can also be blocked

Content Moderation

1	**Lowest**	Generates the most answers; may allow harmful content. Only for narrow, justified use cases.
2	**Medium**	Balanced filtering for general business use
3	**High (Default)**	Recommended starting point for government deployments
4	**Highest**	Strictest filter; generates the fewest answers. Expect some legitimate questions to be blocked.

Set at three levels: agent (Generative AI settings), topic (generative answers node), and prompt tool. Topic-level wins at runtime. Adjust only when a program's use case clearly justifies it.

Permission Trimming

- SharePoint knowledge honors the **asking user's** Microsoft Entra ID permissions
- A user without access to a restricted document gets no answer from that document
- The agent does not expose content the user could not access directly in SharePoint

Security is enforced at retrieval - not just at the chat surface.

Citations by Channel

Teams Channel

Shows at most **20 citations** per response; long titles and snippets are truncated

Custom Responses

Responses rendered through variables or Adaptive Cards **do not get automatic citations**

Citation Instruction

Including an explicit citation instruction in agent instructions improves grounded-answer consistency across all channels

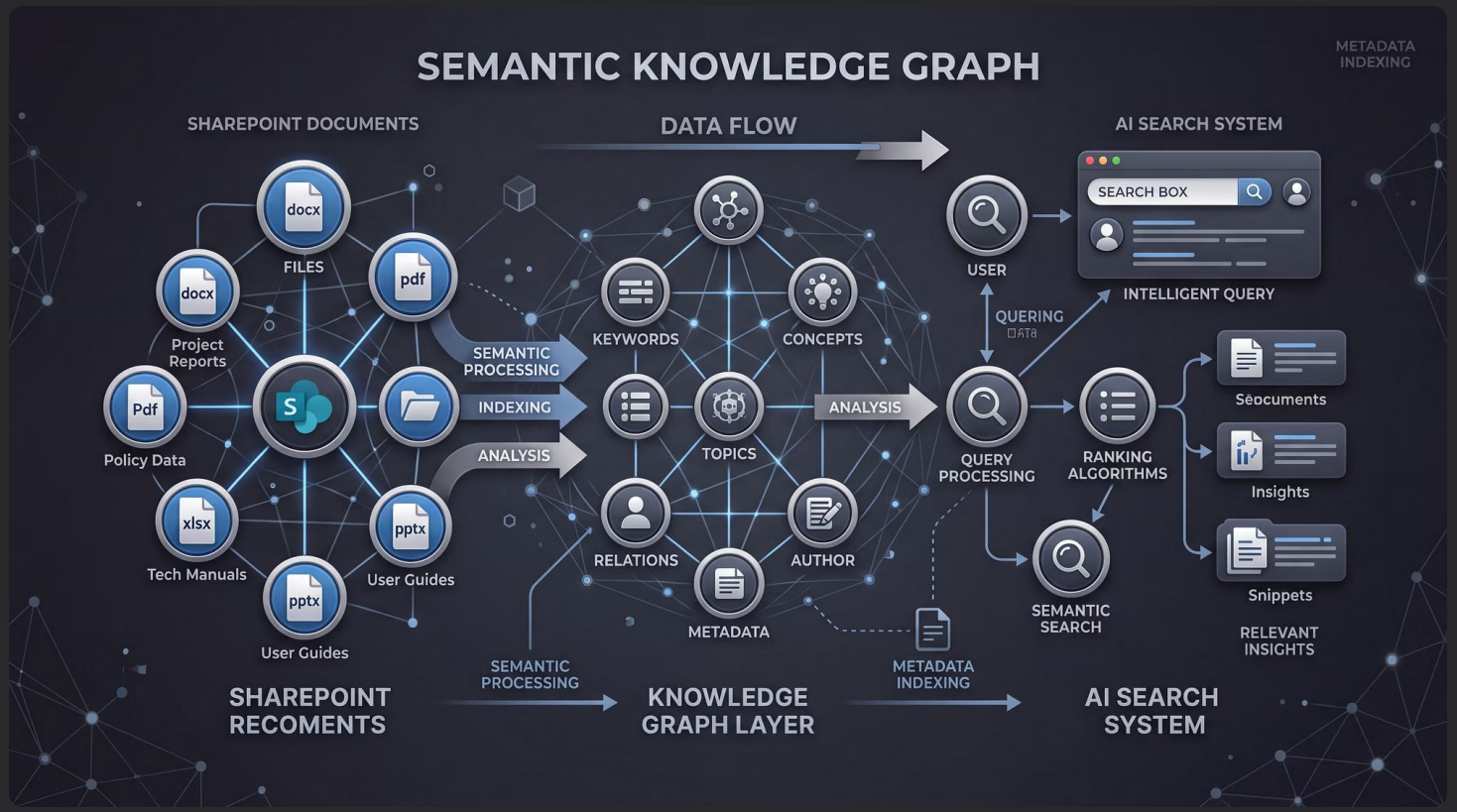
Trust, but Verify

- Show **Allow ungrounded responses off** - out-of-scope question routes to fallback topic
- **Permission wall** - end-user account gets no answer from the restricted document; maker account does
- Show **content moderation level** in Generative AI settings

Tenant Graph Grounding

- Improves SharePoint retrieval with **semantic search**
- Requires "Authenticate with Microsoft" and a Microsoft 365 Copilot license in the tenant
- Confirm availability in the GPO GCC environment before relying on it

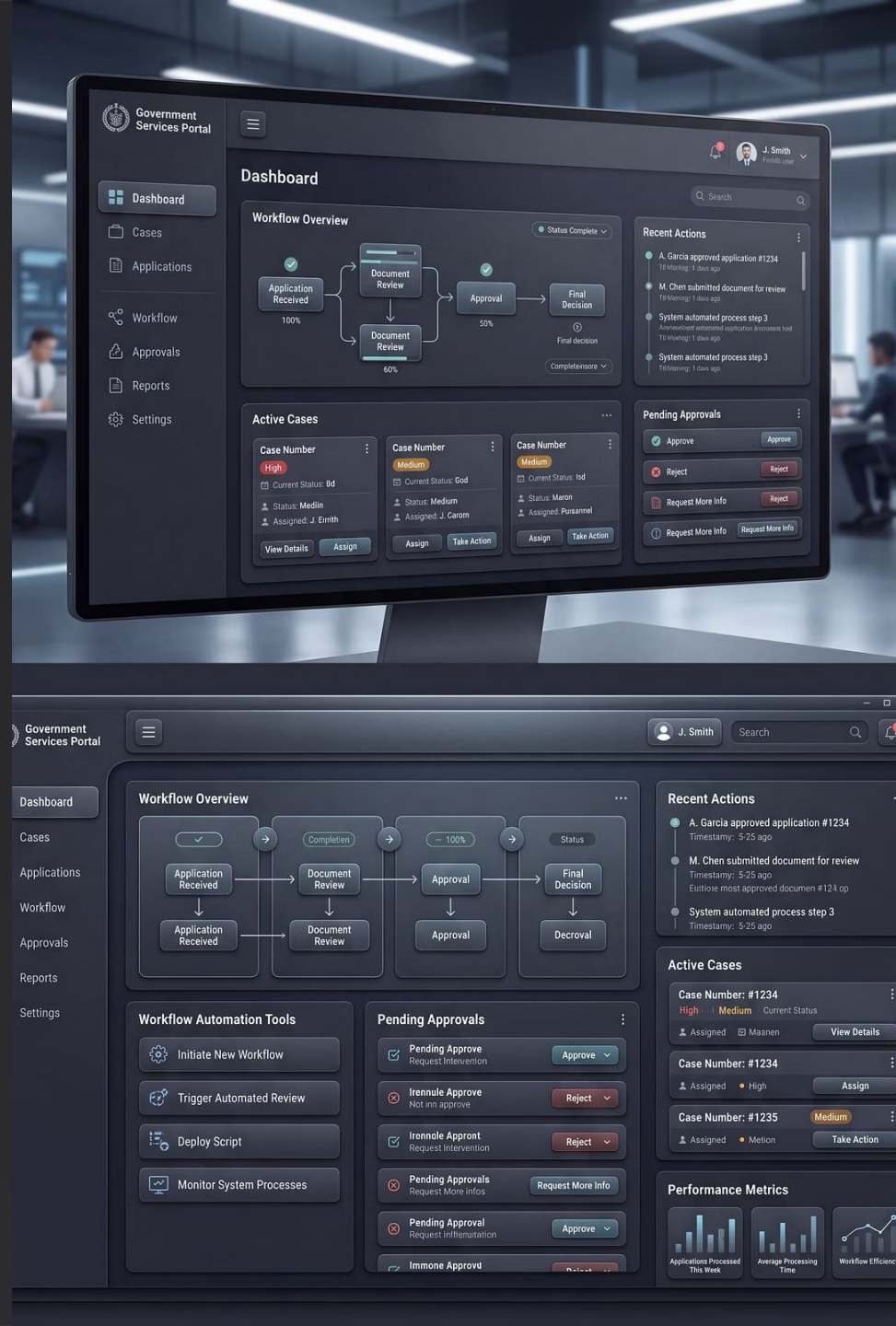
> ⚠ Confirm in your tenant before committing to this capability in a design.



MODULE 3

From Answers to Action

Topics, Tools, and Agent Flows - moving beyond answers to real work in GCC.



Topics Under Generative Orchestration

System Topics

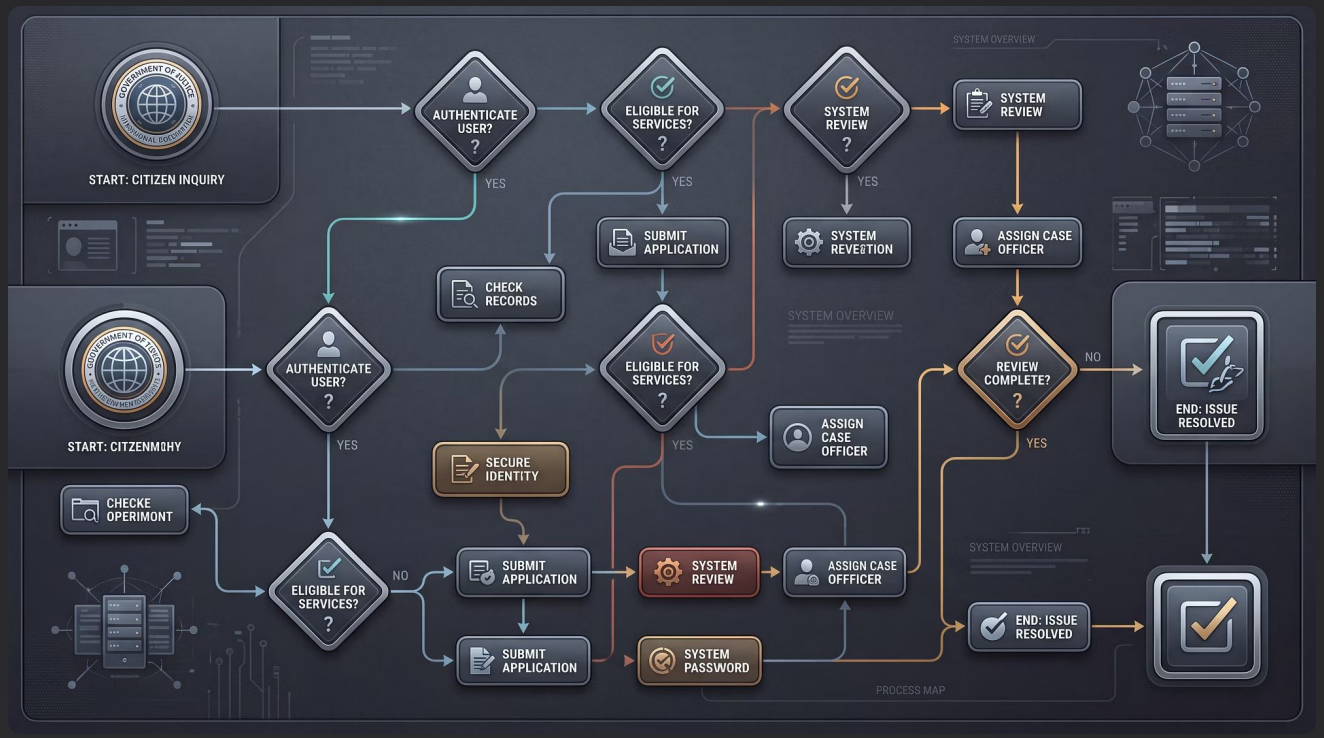
Greeting, fallback, conversational boosting, escalate, end of conversation

Custom Topics

Selected by **description** - not trigger phrases - under generative orchestration

When to Author

Deterministic path: required question sequence, policy disclaimer, or specific escalation



Node Gallery

Message

Send text or Adaptive Cards to the user

Question

Collect input with entities and variables

Condition

Branch logic; condition groups simplify multiple conditions

Adaptive Card

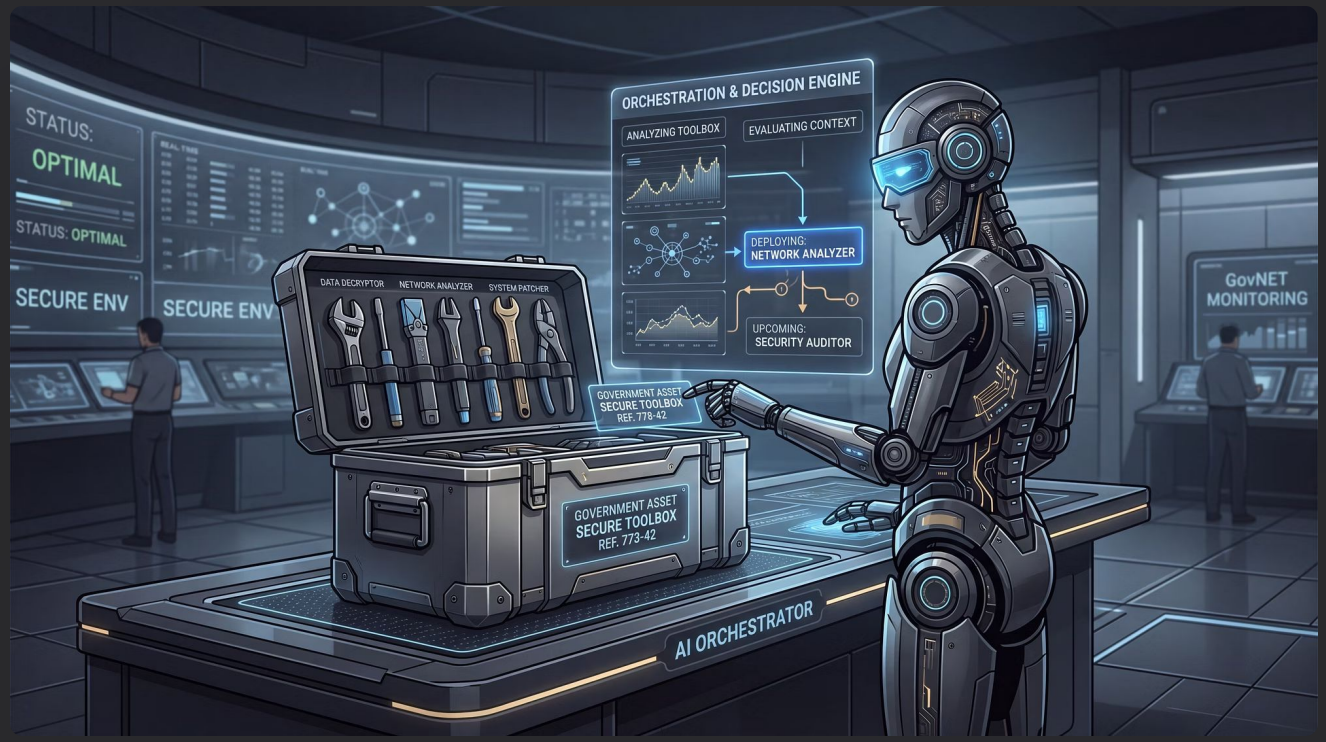
Rich interactive responses

Call a Tool

Invoke a connector, prompt tool, or agent flow

Tool Types – GCC Labels

Tool Type	Description	GCC Status
Connectors	Prebuilt and custom connectors	Available
Prompt Tools	AI Builder prompts returning text or JSON	Available
Agent Flows	Copilot Studio-native flows	Available
REST APIs	Custom HTTP actions	Available
MCP Servers / Computer Use	Advanced AI tool protocols	Not confirmed for GCC



A Good Tool Description

The orchestrator reads tool names and descriptions to decide when to call a tool.

Vague - Orchestrator Skips It

"Handles requests"

Good - Orchestrator Picks It

"Use this tool when the user reports an issue or asks to open a support request. Collects requester name, request type, and description."

Connection Modes

Maker Connection

Simpler setup; tool acts with the maker's permissions. Best for read-only public data or non-sensitive actions.

User Connection

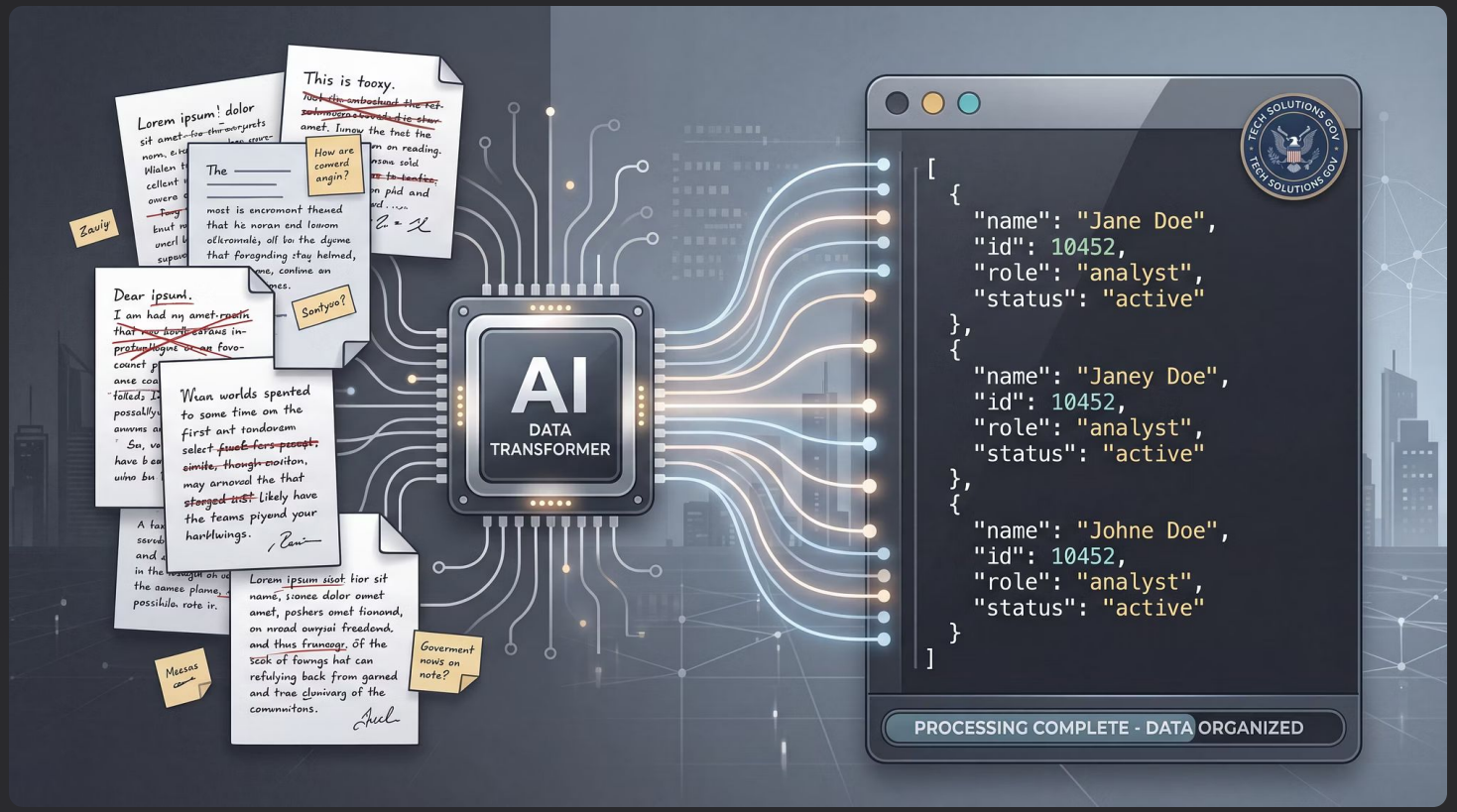
Each person's own access is respected - required for user-specific or sensitive data. Higher setup effort.

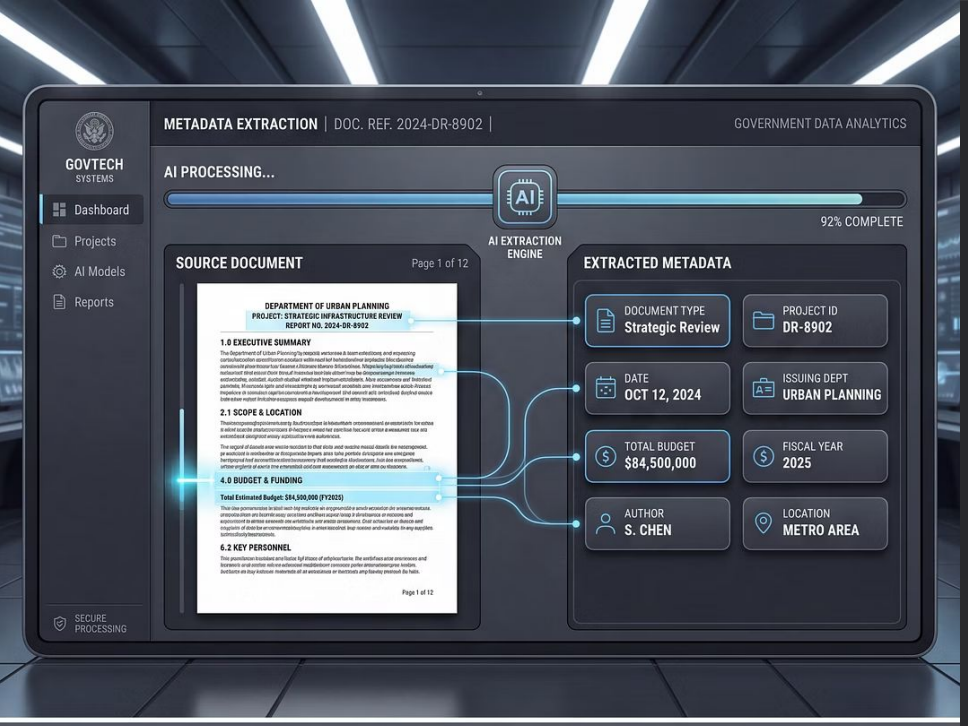
Choose based on the **sensitivity of the data** the tool touches.

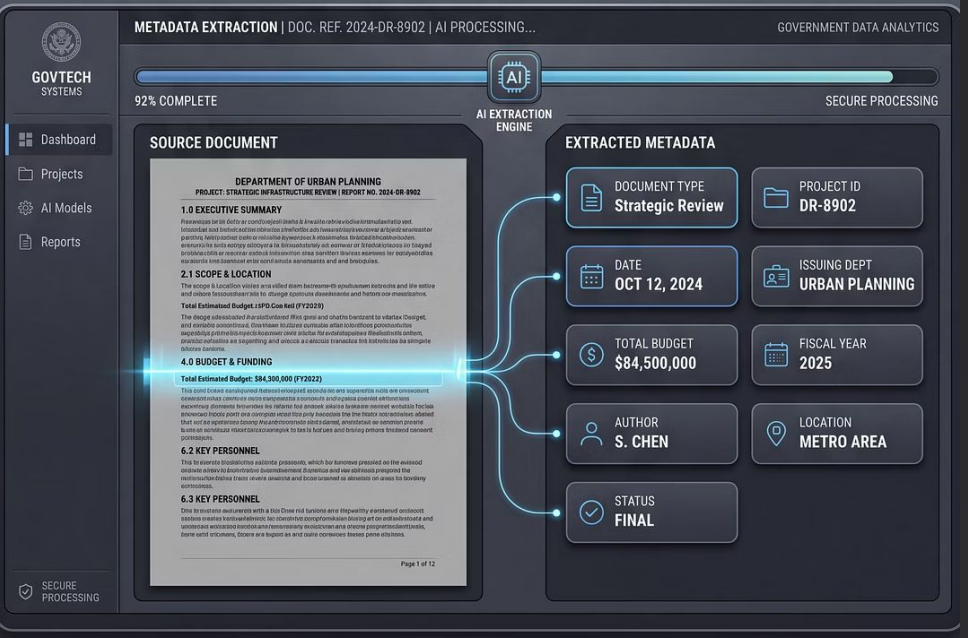
Prompt Tools

- AI Builder prompts with inputs, instructions, and optional knowledge
- Return **text or structured JSON** – ideal for extraction, classification, and rewriting
- Available in GCC as **prompt actions**

Use prompt tools to transform messy input into clean structured data without writing code.







Structured Data from Messy Text

- Add a prompt tool: **"Extract Publication Metadata"** - input is a text block
- Instructions: extract title, issuing agency, publication date, format, classification stem; return JSON
- Test with a messy publication description - show **structured JSON output** in the activity view

Agent Flows and Limits

Trigger

Uses the "When an agent calls the flow" trigger - Copilot Studio-native

Synchronous Limit

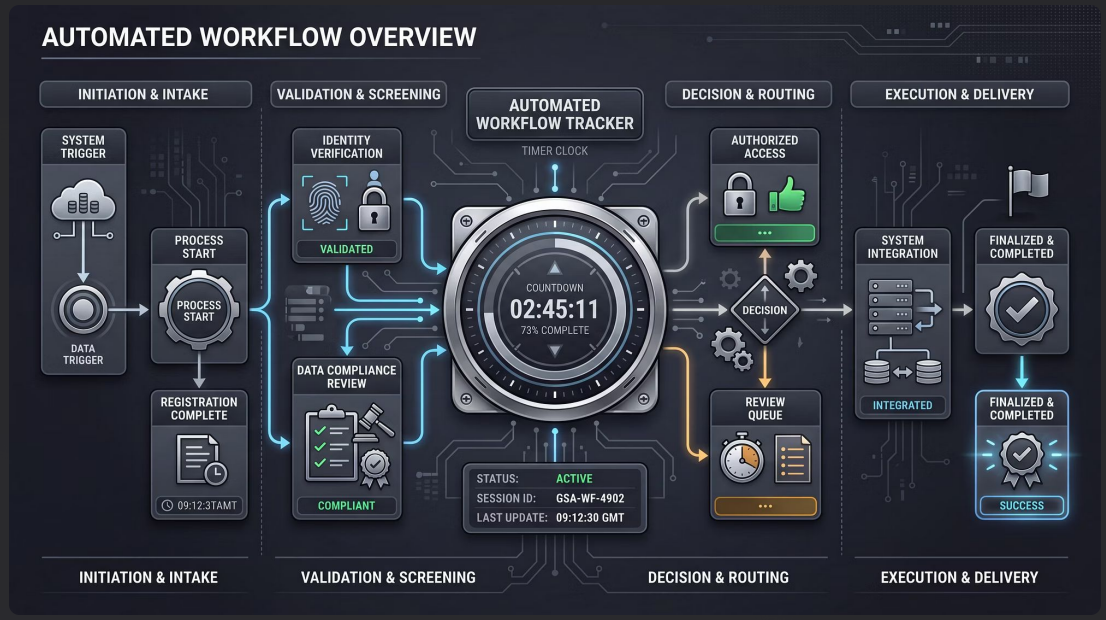
2 minutes; asynchronous responses let long-running flows return results later

Migration

Existing Power Automate cloud flows can be converted to agent flows

Billing

Actions consume Copilot Studio capacity (Copilot Credits)



Human in the Loop

Request Information Action

Pauses a flow to collect input from a reviewer through Outlook. Available in GCC.

Transfer to Agents

Handoff to a live person through a supported engagement hub. Available in GCC.

Delegating to Another Agent

Distinct from human transfer - this is agent-to-agent, covered in Module 5

The Agent Takes Action

- Build an agent flow: **create a SharePoint list item, send a confirmation email, return the request number**
- Add a short instruction to the agent: collect missing fields, confirm, then create the request
- Test: **"A depository library reported a damaged shipment"** - watch the item appear in SharePoint and the email arrive

MODULE 4

Publish, Secure, Govern, and Measure

Getting your agent into users' hands - and keeping it governed, auditable, and measurable in GCC.

Publish and Channels in GCC

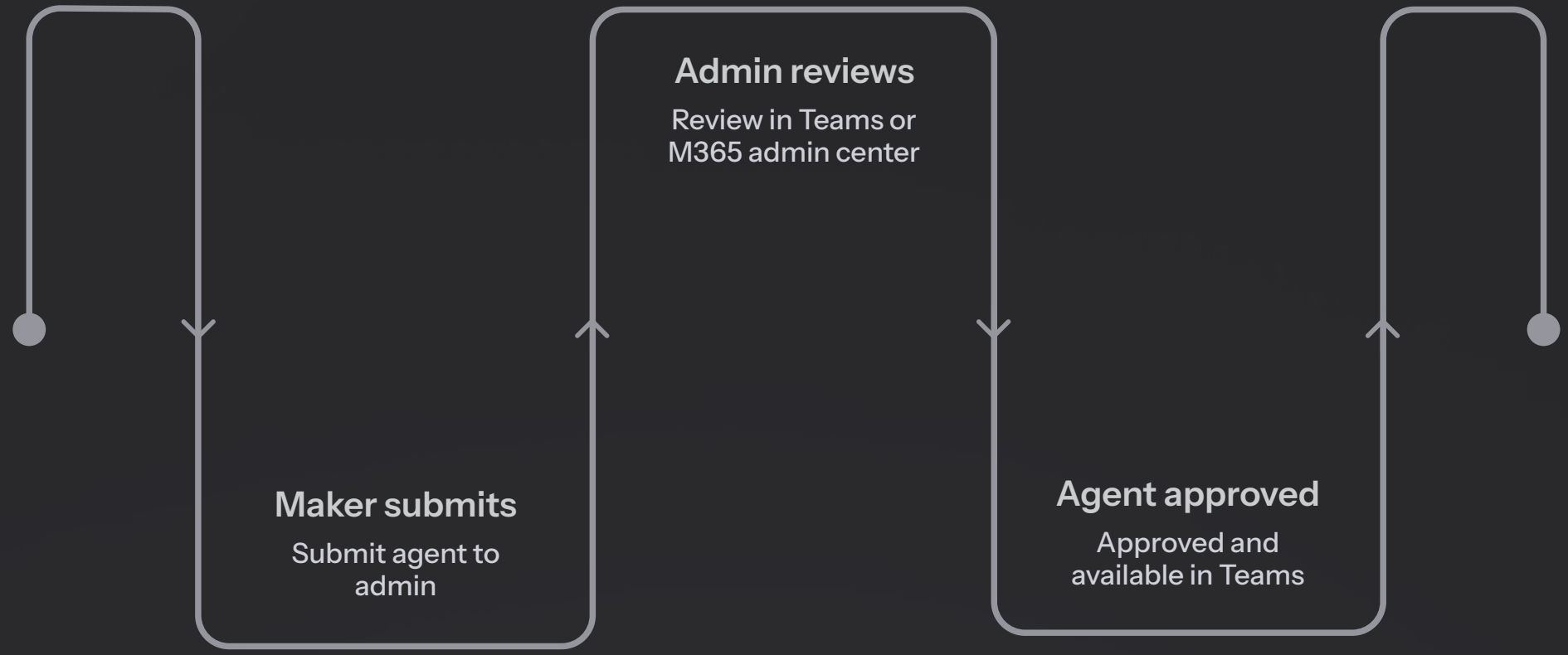
Publishing Creates a Version

A new published version is distributed to all connected channels simultaneously

Available Channels in GCC

Demo website, custom website, Teams and Microsoft 365 Copilot channel, Copilot Studio Teams app

Teams Approval Path in GCC



Sharing and Authentication

Authenticate with Microsoft

Required for SharePoint knowledge and tenant graph grounding. **Use for all internal agents.**

Manual Authentication

For specific OAuth scenarios where you control the identity provider

No Authentication

For public-facing agents only. **Carries different risk** - not recommended for internal content.

Sharing Scope

Share with specific users or security groups to control who can interact with the agent

Microsoft Entra Agent ID

- Automatically created for every new Copilot Studio agent since **July 2026**
- Enables agent-scoped governance: connector permissions, Conditional Access, and DLP scoped to individual agents
- Visible in the Power Platform admin center agent inventory

> One agent = one identity. Governance follows the agent, not just the environment.

Admin Center and DLP

Power Platform Admin Center

Environments, DLP policies, sharing limits, agent inventory, Copilot Credits management

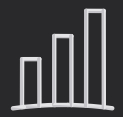
External Connectors

Microsoft 365 Copilot connectors for external and partner data are **not enabled by default** in government clouds

Purview Controls

Available in GCC and apply to interaction data from Copilot

Analytics Overview



Sessions and Engagement

Total sessions, engagement rate, resolution and escalation rates over time

Knowledge Source Use

Which sources are answering questions - critical for tuning knowledge quality

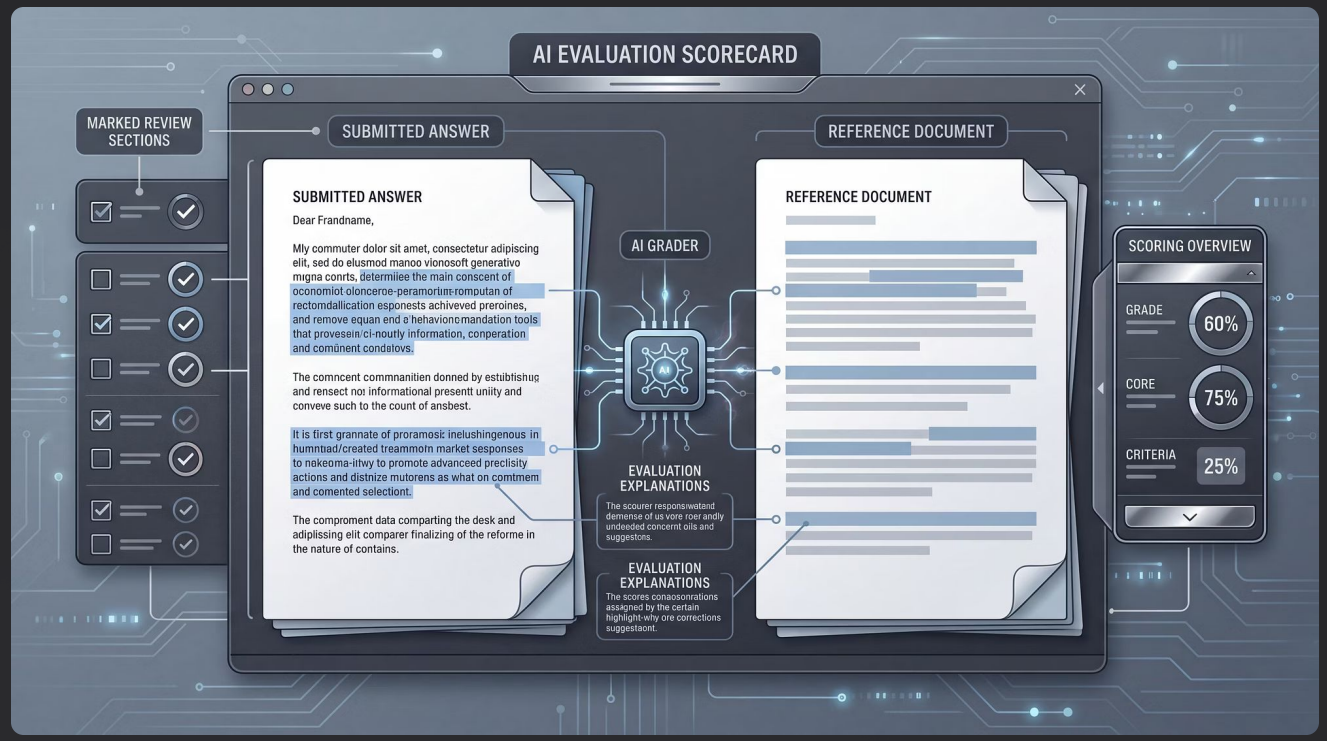
User Signals

User questions, reactions, and emerging themes from conversation data

Agent Evaluations

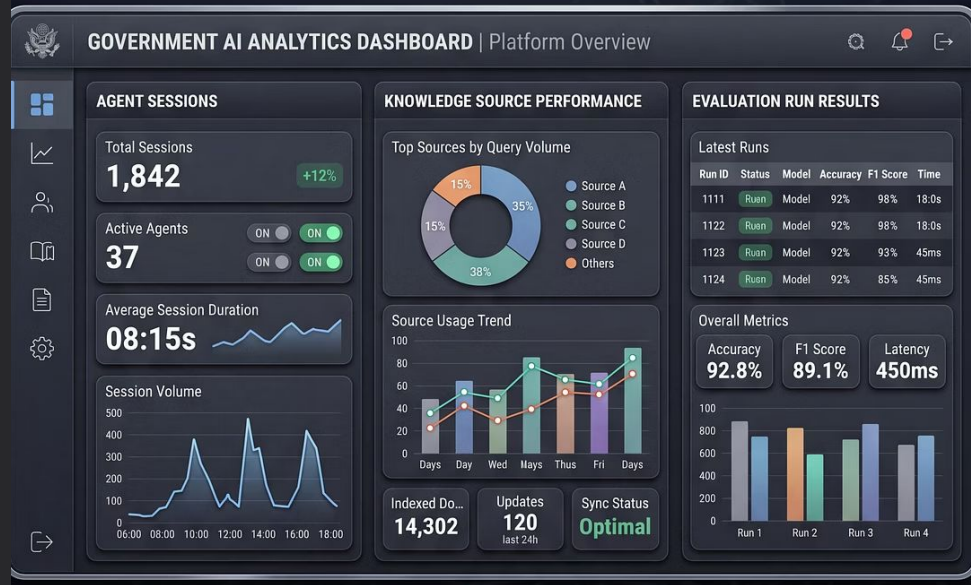
- Generally available in Copilot Studio since **March 2026**; confirm GCC availability in tenant
- Create test sets: upload a CSV, author questions, or generate from conversation history
- Graders score answers against reference answers with explanations
- Supports **multi-turn tests and version comparison**

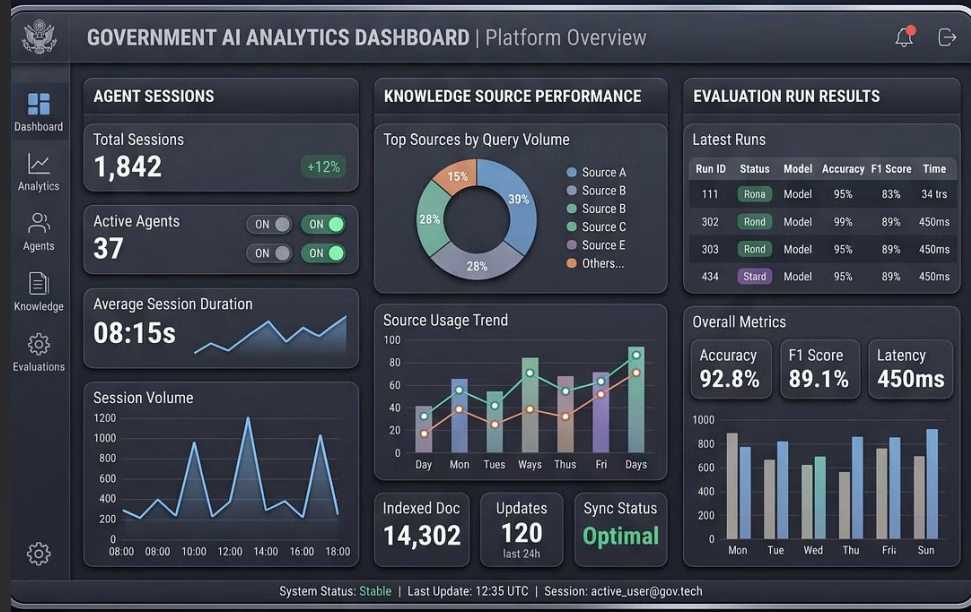
> ⚠ GCC availability not explicitly confirmed - verify in your tenant before relying on this feature.



Prove It Works

- Open analytics for the pre-built agent - **sessions, engagement, knowledge source use**
- Show a completed **evaluation run** with grader explanations
- Open the Power Platform admin center - **Generative AI features, agent inventory, Entra Agent ID**





Governance Quiz

Who can approve an agent for Teams in GCC?

An admin, through the submission process in Teams admin center or Microsoft 365 admin center

Whose permissions does the agent use when searching SharePoint with "Authenticate with Microsoft"?

The asking user's - permission trimming is enforced at retrieval time

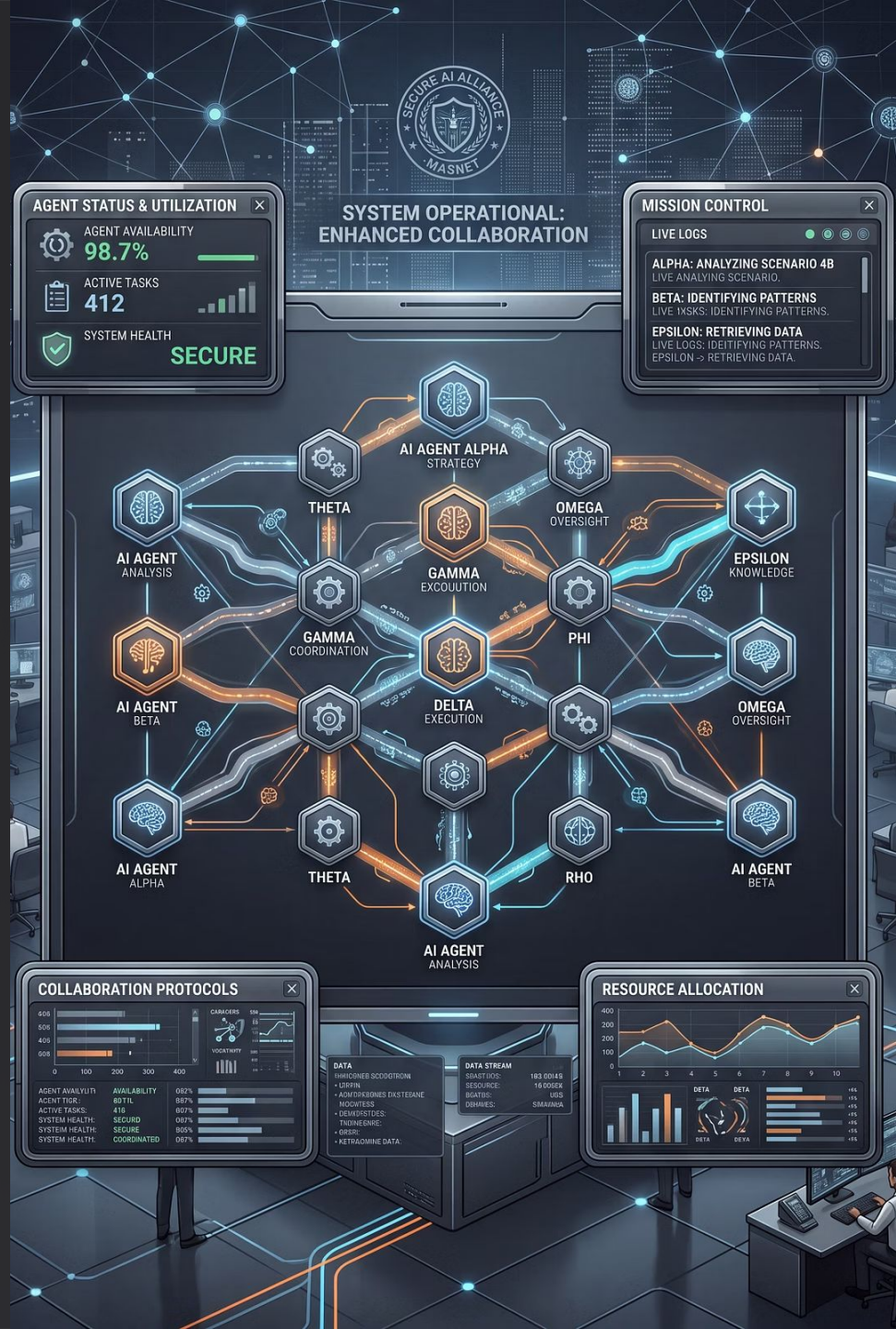
Where do you see every Copilot Studio agent in the organization?

The **agent inventory** in the Power Platform admin center

MODULE 5

Multi-Agent Patterns and the Road Ahead

Composing specialist agents, navigating what is not yet in GCC, and tracking what comes next.



Multi-Agent Patterns Compared

Child Agents

Specialization inside one agent; parent invokes child when the request matches

Connected Agents

A front-door agent delegates to separate specialist agents in the environment

Agent-to-Agent (A2A)

GA since April 2026 for the standard harness; connects agents built on different platforms. Confirm GCC availability.

Transfer to Agents

Handoff to a live person through a supported engagement hub - available in GCC

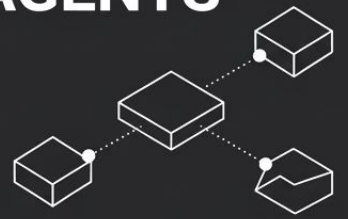
Choosing a Pattern

- **Child agents** - keep a large agent organized; one team owns everything
- **Connected agents** - team ownership boundaries; each team owns its specialist; a front door composes
- **A2A** - integration with agents built outside Copilot Studio; confirm GCC availability before recommending

CHILD AGENTS

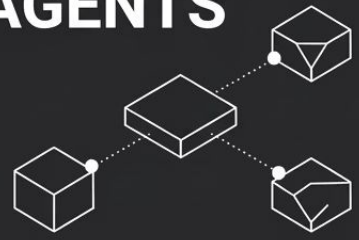
one team,
internal specialization

CONNECTED AGENTS



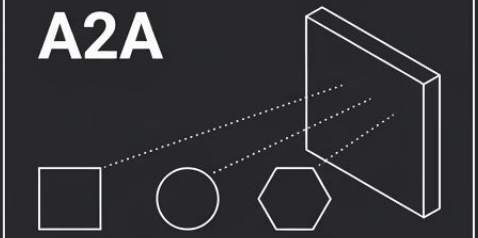
multiple teams,
specialist delegates

CONNECTED AGENTS



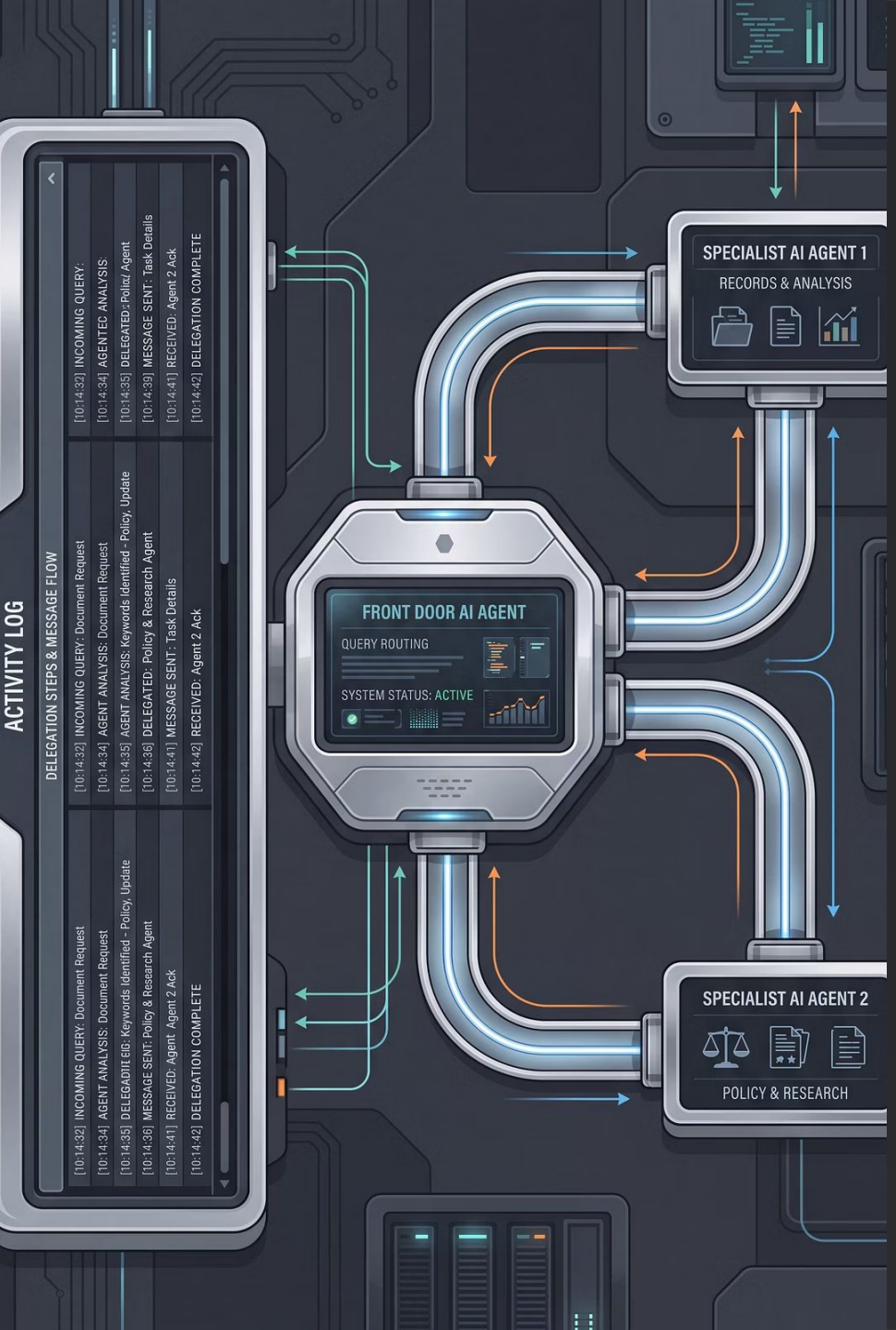
multiple teams

A2A



cross-platform, external agent integration

Confirm GCC



The Front Door

- Open the pre-built **Front Door agent** - routing instructions only; two connected specialists listed
- Ask the blended question - activity view shows **delegation to each specialist** and the composed answer
- Ask a follow-up for one specialist only - show **single routing** in action

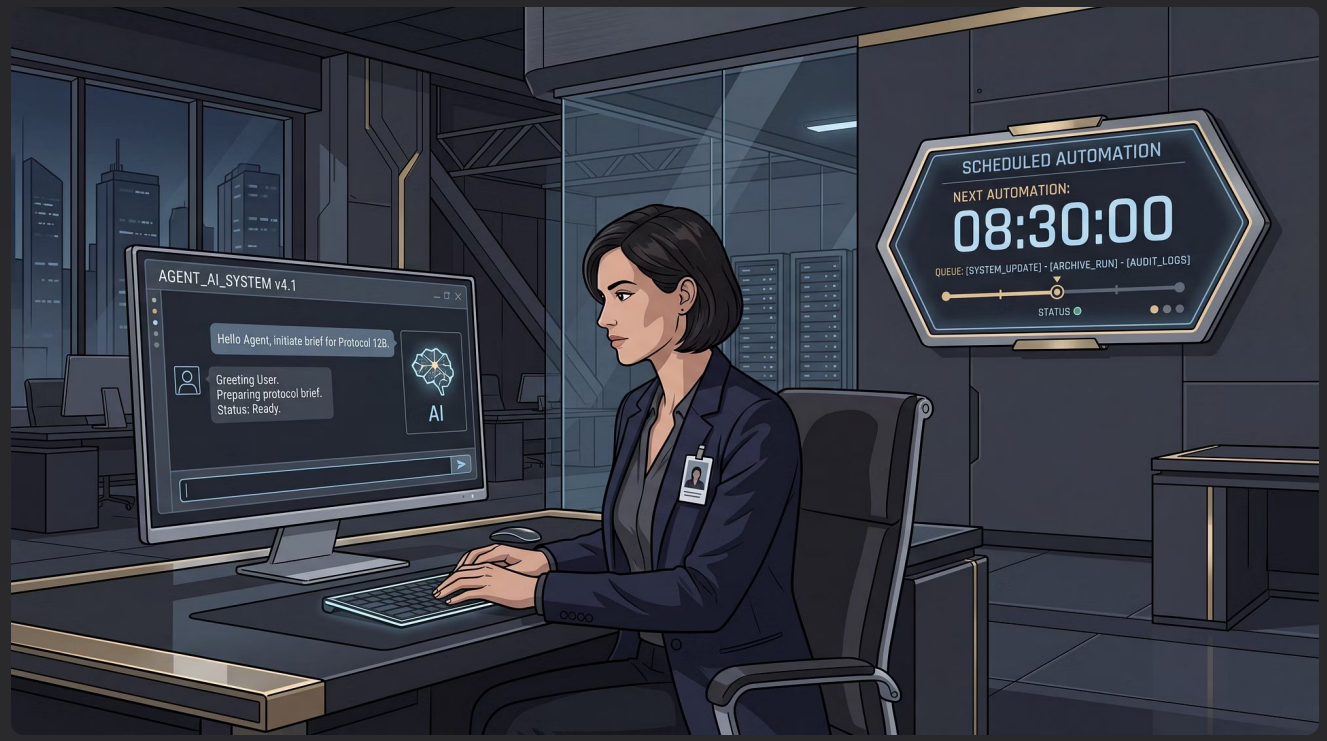
Autonomous Triggers and Interim Patterns

⊗ Autonomous triggers (event-based agent starts) are **not available in GCC today**.

Interim Pattern

Keep the agent as the conversational surface people initiate. Use **scheduled Power Automate cloud flows** for time-based automation that feeds the agent's context.

Watch the **Copilot Studio for US Government customers** page for changes to autonomous trigger availability.



The GitHub Copilot Harness

What It Offers (Commercial)

- Generally available in commercial clouds since **August 3, 2026**
- Natural-language Build tab, skills, memory across interactions
- Native file creation, MCP servers, Copilot Credits billing

GCC Status

Not listed on the GCC feature page. **Treat as not yet available** unless the option appears in your tenant.

Remember: this is a Copilot Studio runtime framework - not the GitHub Copilot developer service.

Not Yet in GCC

Model Selection

No model picker - GPT-4o only; no preview models for answer generation

Enhanced and Azure AI Search

Generative Answers Enhanced Search and Azure AI Search as a knowledge source

Computer Use and MCP

Computer use and most Microsoft-published MCP connectors not confirmed for GCC

GitHub Copilot Harness

GA in commercial, not yet listed for GCC

How to Track GCC Availability

01

Copilot Studio for US Government

learn.microsoft.com - primary source for GCC capability status

02

Copilot Studio What's New

Monthly release notes with GCC callouts

03

Microsoft 365 Roadmap

Filter for GCC to see upcoming features

04

Message Center and Public Sector Blog

Tenant-level announcements and government-specific guidance

Pro-Code Escalation Paths

Microsoft 365 Agents SDK

Full developer control over the agent runtime; deploy to channels of your choice. Note: Agents Toolkit publishing is not supported in Government tenants today.

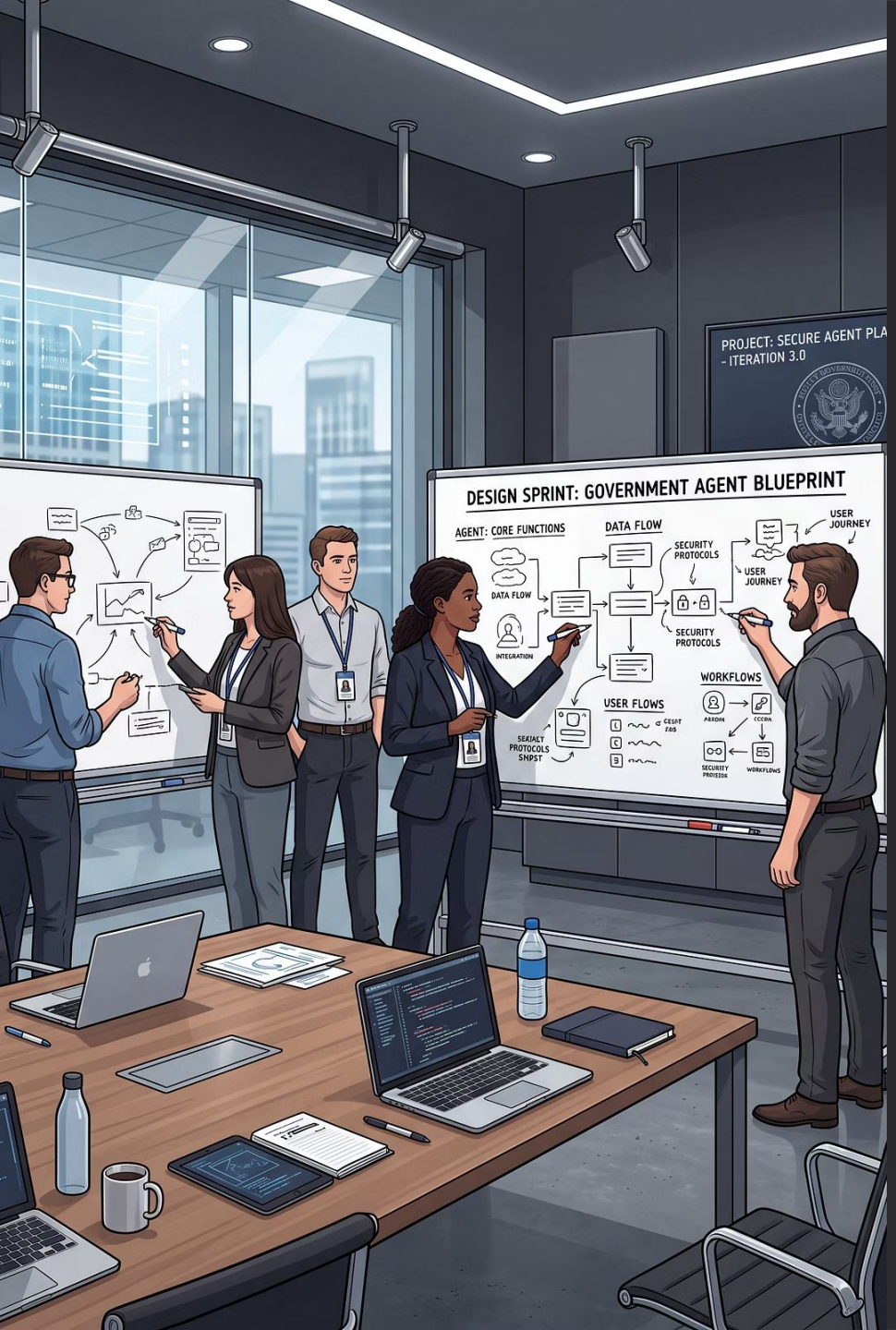
Microsoft Foundry

Unified platform for enterprise AI operations, models, and agent services when requirements exceed low-code. Formerly Azure AI Foundry.

Microsoft Agent Framework

Open-source SDK and runtime for AI agents and multi-agent workflows; the convergence of Semantic Kernel and AutoGen. Supports MCP and A2A.

Escalate when requirements exceed what **low-code can deliver**. Confirm the GCC deployment path for each before committing.



MODULE 6

Capstone Design Sprint

Design your own agent - from a blank canvas to a GCC-ready blueprint your program area can act on.

Agent Canvas

Name and Purpose

One sentence: who it serves and what it does

Users and Channel

Who asks, and where: Teams, Copilot Chat, or a web page

Knowledge

Which SharePoint libraries, documents, or lists; who keeps them current

Tools and Actions

What it should do, and which connector or flow that implies

Guardrails

Scope, tone, escalation path, ungrounded responses, moderation level

Success Measure

One metric to check in analytics after 30 days

GCC Readiness Check

1 List Capabilities

List every capability your design relies on

2 Flag Gaps

Flag any that are not available in GCC today

3 Note Interim Patterns

Note the interim pattern for each flagged item

4 Confirm in Tenant

Verify in your GPO GCC tenant before committing to a timeline

Resources

Copilot Studio for US Government Customers

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/requirements-licensing-gcc

What's New in Copilot Studio

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/whats-new

Harnesses in Copilot Studio

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/harnesses-overview

Knowledge Sources Summary

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/knowledge-copilot-studio

Publish to Teams and Microsoft 365 Copilot

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/publication-add-bot-to-microsoft-teams

Glossary: Current Terminology

Term	Definition
Agent	AI-powered assistant defined by instructions, knowledge, tools, and an orchestrator
Harness	The runtime between agent configuration and the model
Generative Orchestration	Model selects knowledge, tools, and topics by description - not trigger phrases
Agent Flow	Copilot Studio-native flow using the "When an agent calls the flow" trigger
Copilot Credits	The common currency for Copilot Studio usage billing

What Changed Recently

1

Aug 2025

Copilot Studio Agent Builder GA in GCC

2

Mar 2026

Agent evaluations GA; GPT-5 and Claude models GA - **excluding GCC**

3

Apr 2026

Agent-to-agent protocol GA; Agent Builder and Copilot Studio publishing to Teams in GCC

4

Jul 2026

Entra Agent ID automatically created for all new agents

5

Aug 2026

GitHub Copilot harness GA worldwide - **not yet listed for GCC**

Thank You - and Please Complete the Survey

You Built It

A help desk agent went from blank screen to Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat

You Designed It

An Agent Canvas for your own program area, ready to share with your team

You're Ready

A GCC readiness checklist and a curated Microsoft Learn reading list to guide next steps

Questions? Parking lot items will be answered within **two business days**.